

DynoWeb ICP — The Definitive Profile

Status: Canonical. This is the one document we follow. Every outreach list, listing keyword, landing headline, and channel bet is checked against it. If a decision contradicts this doc, either the decision is wrong or this doc needs a documented update — never both silently.

Established: 2026-07-17 · **Method:** DynoWeb repo docs (phi losophy .md, founder docs) + live production DB + primary-source web research (Shopify Community threads, App Store reviews, SEC filings, Store Leads). Blogspam and uncited statistics were actively rejected.

The ICP, in one sentence

A US or EU Shopify store doing 5,000–50,000 sessions/month in Beauty/Personal-Care or Apparel, that just changed something — a redesign, a theme swap, a migration, or a new paid-ads push — and is now watching sales fall or flatline while traffic holds, with no dev on call and no idea which specific thing broke.

The trigger is what turns a fit into a *now*. Without it you have a store that qualifies but won't buy this month.

1. The binding constraint is detectability — not willingness to pay

This is the core insight, and it inverts the usual way of picking an ICP.

The value bar is trivially easy to clear. A sustained +0.5pp conversion lift is worth:

Sessions/mo	AOV \$30	AOV \$60	AOV \$100
1,000	\$150	\$300	\$500
5,000	\$750	\$1,500	\$2,500
25,000	\$3,750	\$7,500	\$12,500

At ~580–1,900 sessions/month a merchant already gets 10x ROI on \$29/mo. So "can they afford it / is it worth it" is not the constraint — almost any real store clears that.

The constraint is whether our instruments can see anything at their traffic level:

Instrument	Minimum traffic to be honest	Consequence below it
Session replay	20–30 recordings	Works — this is our zero-traffic-ish asset
Static store/theme/SEO scan	0 sessions	Works — philosophy P4's first-session value
Heatmaps	400–600 per page (200–300 per device type), 1,000+ to act	"Noise dressed up as signal" — 4 users clicking the same spot looks like a hotspot
Nudge attribution	~5,000+/mo for a credible read	Attribution numbers we can't stand behind
A/B test (+10% lift)	~161,000–216,000 sessions	Arithmetically unavailable to our entire market

The consequence, stated plainly: A/B testing can never be DynoWeb's proof mechanism. It is out of reach for every store in our ICP and beyond it. Replay (works at 30) and per-nudge attribution are the only honest evidence we can offer. Anyone who asks us to "prove it with a split test" is asking for something the math doesn't allow at this store size — say so, and show replay + attribution instead.

The gap that defines us

Between ~2,000 and ~20,000 sessions/month, a conversion lift is **worth real money but cannot be proven by A/B test**. That gap is our market. Stores in it need someone to *see* the problem for them, because they can't test their way to it. That is exactly what we sell.

The floor and the ceiling

- **Floor:** ~5,000 sessions/month for a *paying* customer. Below this, heatmaps are noise and attribution isn't credible — we'd be selling a mirror that can't focus. **This is physics, not preference.** (Our FREE tier at 1,500 sessions honestly serves below-floor stores with the static scan + replay. That is the correct home for them — not a paid plan.)
- **Ceiling:** ~50,000 sessions/month. Above this they hire CRO agencies (Speero gates at 100k uniques / \$10k/mo) and buy real experimentation platforms. We lose to specialists.

Our pricing already encodes this — confirm it, don't fight it

Tier	Sessions	Who it's actually for
Free \$0	1,500	Below-floor stores. Static scan + replay. Not a failed sale — the right home.
Growth \$14	7,500	← THE ICP TIER. Sits right above the 5,000 detectability floor.
Pro \$29	35,000	Upper ICP, approaching the agency ceiling
Custom \$39+	100k+	Above ICP — rare, mostly bespoke

Growth (\$14 / 7,500 sessions) is the ICP product. Everything in acquisition should aim a merchant at that tier. This is a strong signal we priced right even before we knew why.

2. The qualification gates (a lead passes ALL of these, or it isn't a lead)

#	Gate	Pass	Reject
1	Traffic	5,000–50,000 sessions/mo	<5,000 (can't see) · >50,000 (agency buys)
2	Vertical	Beauty & Personal Care, Apparel/Fashion	Jewelry/Luxury, Home & Furniture (see §3)
3	Geography	US, UK, EU, CA, AU	India (see §4)
4	Trigger	Redesign/migration/theme change, or new/scaled paid ads, in the last ~90 days	No trigger = qualifies but won't buy now
5	Baseline	Store is ≥6 months old with a conversion-rate history to miss	Brand-new store — nothing to compare against, and usually pre-product-market-fit
6	Ownership	Owner/ops lead reachable, no dev team on call	Has an in-house dev/CRO team → they build or buy enterprise

Gate 5 deserves emphasis. **An established store that *used to* convert and now doesn't is our best customer,** because the problem is a specific, findable regression — not "my whole business idea is unproven." A brand-new

store with no sales usually has a product/market problem that no heatmap can fix, and telling them otherwise violates philosophy P8 (honesty over hype).

3. Vertical — and the trap

Target: Beauty & Personal Care first, Apparel/Fashion second. These are also the two largest Shopify categories (Apparel 780,769 stores / 27.2%; Beauty & Fitness 312,461 / 10.9% — Store Leads).

The counterintuitive part — sessions needed to read a +10% lift, by vertical baseline CR:

Vertical	Typical CR	Sessions to prove +10%	Verdict
Beauty & Personal Care	5.37%	~58,000	Best — highest CR = fastest signal
Fashion / Apparel	2.81%	~114,000	Good — plus it's the biggest category
Home & Furniture	1.2%	~271,000	Weak
Luxury & Jewelry	0.71%	~460,000	AVOID — the trap

The jewelry/luxury trap. Highest AOV (\$386), lowest CR (0.71%) — it *looks* like the perfect CRO customer: lots of money on the table per conversion. It is the worst one. It needs **8x Beauty's traffic** to produce a readable signal, while burning through our session-metered cap the entire way. **Under a session-based paywall, low-CR verticals are structurally our worst-margin customers.** Low CR is a cost, not an opportunity.

This is not academic — see §7. Our single highest-traffic store is a jewelry store converting at 0.20%. It is our best-looking lead and our worst-fitting one.

4. Geography — US/EU, not India

The evidence is one-directional and the founder being India-based does not change it:

- **Market size:** US 1,090,648 Shopify stores (38.0%) vs India 121,839 (4.2%) — 8.9x (Store Leads, Jul 2026).
- **Spending power:** India doesn't reach the top-6 Plus countries despite 4.2% store share — a heavy under-index. US sits at parity (38.0% stores / 37.5% Plus).
- **The decisive fact — we cannot price for India even if we wanted to.** Shopify's managed pricing has **no per-country pricing**. Local currency billing (INR) is supported, but that is a display/settlement feature, not regional pricing. A \$14 plan is \$14 everywhere. Shopify's own pricing discounts India 47% on Basic — we structurally cannot match that gesture.
- **The metric itself is corrupted in India:** COD RTO hits 58% in festive season (Unicommerce D2C Report 2026, 6,000+ brands). A large share of Indian "conversions" never become revenue — which poisons the exact number a CRO app sells against. We'd be optimizing a lie.

Being India-based is a cost advantage. It is not a market signal. Decouple them. Convenient: India over-indexes in Apparel (47,683 stores, 1.45x), so a Beauty+Apparel focus doesn't *exclude* Indian merchants — we just don't *price, target, or build* for them.

5. Trigger events — ranked by evidence strength

1 · Post-redesign / theme change / migration — the BEST trigger (use this one) An established store with a baseline it can miss. Verbatim, from Shopify Community:

"In the last few years our conversation rate has dropped off a cliff to now around 0.3/4 we use to be around 1.8." — baby boutique owner, Feb 2026

Resolution 3 weeks later: *"We found out what this was. The discount code was not applying in the cart drawer slider. Fixed it and it was like night and day."*

Every community responder guessed wrong — they blamed emojis, cluttered navigation, missing trust badges. The actual cause was a technical bug that only session replay or storefront error tracking would have caught, and it cost her ~1.4pp of conversion for weeks. **That thread is our entire product thesis, documented in the wild by a stranger.** Use it as the reference case.

2 · Started or scaled paid ads — the highest-volume trigger Nearly every "traffic but no sales" post is ad-triggered. Verbatim:

"I am getting a decent amount of sessions per day (~300) but I am not getting ANY sales." "I had about 2,500 visitors over the 10 days... I've only had 3 add-to-carts and zero sales."

Caution: many of these are brand-new stores failing Gate 5 — the pain is loud but the store is often pre-PMF. Filter hard on store age and baseline.

3 · BFCM / seasonal — WEAK, do not build on it. Searching produced Shopify-staff and vendor checklists, **not merchant distress posts.** Plausible, unevidenced.

6. Vocabulary — verified, refuted, and the one we use

Full guide: the complete, per-feature, paste-able version lives in [dynoweb-vocabulary.md](#) — use that when writing any ad, page, listing, or email. This section is the ICP-level summary; the vocab doc adds two more verified bans ("**nudge**" → say "popup"; "**attribution**" → say "what's making you money"), the emotional tone, and ready copy for all 16 features.

This section is binding on all copy: listing, site, outreach, video.

Phrase	Verdict	Evidence
"lost sales"	■ THE category phrase — use it	MIDA: "Fix lost sales: live replays..." · Propel: "Fix lost sales: record session replays..." · Plerdy: "Avoid lost sales..." — three competitors independently converged on the same words
"traffic but no sales"	■ VERIFIED merchant vocabulary	Six+ Shopify Community thread titles use it near-verbatim: "Have visitors but no sales", "Over 1000 Visitors No Sales", "High website traffic, but no sales"
"drop off" / "stuck" / "friction"	■ Merchant verbs, from their own reviews	"where customers drop off or get stuck", "spot where visitors get stuck, what they ignore"
"conversion rate"	■ Native merchant vocabulary	"Conversion rate dropped off a cliff", "Plummeting Conversion Rate"

Phrase	Verdict	Evidence
"leaking funnel" / "funnel leak"	■ REFUTED — vendor vocabulary	Zero merchant posts found. Only vendor marketing (Shopify's own blog, OptiMonk, HulkApps). Using it = speaking vendor-to-vendor
"CRO"	■ REFUTED — vendor vocabulary	Every CRO-titled community thread was posted by an app vendor or consultant, with vendor repliers. The CRO threads are vendors talking to each other
"AI CRO Expert"	■ Dead on both counts	Merchant says neither "CRO" nor "expert"; and "AI-powered" is now table-stakes (Clarity free, MIDA \$9.90, Propel scaled)

The dominant merchant verbs are: **see · watch · spot · find**. Merchants want to *see*.

■■ **Tension to hold consciously.** "Fix lost sales" is proven to be what merchants respond to — and it's the *exact* tagline MIDA and Propel already use. Match it for **discovery** (it's what they search and recognize); do **not** stop there for **differentiation**. Our distinct claim is the loop — *diagnose from replay/error data → deploy the nudge → attribute the money, in one app*. Same door, different room.

7. The reality check: our current installed base is NOT our ICP

This is the most important finding in this document, and it reframes the whole distribution plan. Pulled live from production, 2026-07-17 (TrafficDailyRollup, 30-day window):

Store	Sessions /30d	CR	Currency	Vertical	ICP verdict
mexican-oaxacan-silver-jewelry	5,511	0.20%	USD	jewelry	■■ Only store above floor — in the trap vertical
freshleafindia	2,540	1.18%	INR	—	■ Below floor · wrong geo (best revenue: \$11.3k/30d)
esselbath1	2,050	0.00%	INR	—	■ Below floor · zero conversions (broken?)
cofainc	1,481	0.00%	CAD	—	■ Below floor
sahasika (partner)	1,104	0.18%	INR	fashion/ethnic	■ Below floor · wrong geo
bd00fa-3	940	0.00%	USD	home/furniture	■ Below floor · weak vertical
kitchener-printkia	687	0.87%	CAD	—	■ Below floor
skyline-decor	681	0.15%	USD	—	■ Below floor
...11 more	<700	—	mostly INR	—	■ Far below floor

Verdict: zero of our ~18 real stores sit in the ICP. Exactly one clears the traffic floor, and it is jewelry — the one vertical we should avoid. The base skews heavily INR. Most stores are 5–10x below the floor where our instruments can honestly see anything.

What this actually means — read this twice

Our 0 paying customers is not a sales problem or a pricing problem. It is an acquisition-targeting problem. We have been acquiring stores that are *structurally incapable* of getting recurring value from the product. They install, the heatmap shows noise (because 400 sessions can't fill one), there's nothing to act on, and they never pay. That is the honest mechanism, and it's consistent with every number above.

Three consequences, all uncomfortable:

- 1 The warm-18 is a weak source of paying customers.** Earlier planning assumed warm converts fastest (3–5 paying). On this evidence that is optimistic — most of them are below the floor where we can deliver honestly, and selling to them anyway would violate philosophy P8. They are still the **best source of interviews** (they're real merchants who installed and can say why they stalled) — just not the best source of revenue. **Interview them; don't count on their money.** The exception: **mexican-oaxacan-silver-jewelry** is capped and above-floor — a real upgrade conversation, despite the vertical.
- 2 The named-50 list must be built from stores we do not have yet.** The ICP is a *hunting* spec, not a description of our base.
- 3 Free-tier below-floor installs are not failures** — they're correctly-placed. But they should never be counted as pipeline, and the plan's targets must not assume they convert.

Data gap worth fixing

Shop.businessType is **null for 13 of 18 real stores** — we cannot segment our own base by vertical. Since vertical is now an ICP gate, this field should be populated (it's already inferred for some stores via businessTypeSource). Cheap fix, high leverage.

8. The anti-ICP — who we explicitly do not serve

Saying this out loud is what makes the ICP real. We do **not** serve:

- **Stores under ~5,000 sessions/mo** on a *paid* plan. Our instruments can't see. Free tier is their honest home. Selling them Growth is a refund and a 1-star review.
- **Brand-new stores with no sales.** Usually a product/market problem. No heatmap fixes that, and pretending otherwise is the fabrication philosophy P8 forbids.
- **Jewelry / luxury.** The trap. Low CR = unreadable signal + worst margin under a session cap.
- **India-based merchants** as a *target* (they're welcome, we just don't build/price/hunt for them).
- **Stores with an in-house dev or CRO team.** They build it or buy enterprise (FullStory, Contentsquare).
- **>50,000 sessions/mo.** They hire agencies and buy experimentation platforms.
- **Anyone who needs an A/B test as proof.** Arithmetically impossible at this store size — we'd be promising what we can't deliver.

9. Two competitive facts the ICP must respect

1 • Heatmaps and replays cannot be what we charge for. Microsoft Clarity set that price at \$0 and out-reviewed the entire paid field (1,570 reviews) within 12 months. MIDA undercuts our \$14 at **\$9.90 for 5,000 sessions** with a **4.9★**. Our \$14/7,500 wins marginally on sessions-per-dollar, and our free tier (1,500 vs MIDA's 250) is 6x more generous — but we are still priced above the category's most-loved paid entry while a free competitor gives away more. **The mirror is a commodity. The act is the product** (philosophy P1).

2 • Clarity's 1-star reviews tell us where the money is — and it isn't features:

"the system would not let me log in or properly link my account" "no support available. I've repeatedly emailed microsoft... I get zero response." "Very difficult for a shopkeeper/retailer to grasp" "popup makes the data basically unusable... site content is all garbled"

Every complaint is "I can't set it up / can't read it / nobody helps me." Not one is "I want more features." That maps exactly onto philosophy P6 (*plain language over jargon, one clear next action*) and P1 (*act, don't mirror*). Setup, comprehensibility, support, and Shopify-native context are the wedge against free.

■■■ **Moat honesty check.** Wisepops and OptiMonk (4.7★, free to 10k pageviews, \$29/20k) **already ship popups with revenue attribution and A/B testing.** "Deployed intervention + attribution" is *not* itself unique. What is plausibly unique is the **loop** — diagnose → deploy → attribute, in one app. Pressure-test that claim before it becomes load-bearing marketing.

3 · **Bot filtering is an ICP-level risk, not a hygiene task.** MIDA's 1-star reviews are dominated by it:

"MIDA recorded 350+ 'sessions'... all clearly bot traffic. Consumed my entire free 250-session limit immediately. NO bot filtering. All data meaningless."

We bill on session count. philosophy P5 already anticipates this; the research confirms it is the category's **#1 trust wound**. Filtering bots before the billing counter is the difference between 4.9★ and 1★ — and at our ICP's traffic level, bot pollution also destroys the signal we sell.

10. Market sizing — with honest error bars

Each step below is **our assumption, not data**. The real Shopify revenue distribution is not publicly knowable (Shopify hasn't disclosed merchant counts since 2021; every "5.6M stores / 13.95% make >\$10k" statistic in circulation is uncited blogspam — the false-precision decimal is the tell).

2.87M live Shopify storefronts	(Store Leads — the one defensible count, triangulated against Shopify's SEC-filed \$205M MRR)
× ~16.7% that pay for any app	(83.3% pay \$0 for apps — directional, ±25%)
× ~25% at ≥5,000 sessions/mo	(assumption — no public data exists)
× ~50% with adequate AOV/vertical	(assumption)
≈ ~60,000 serviceable stores	
× 1% capture × \$29/mo	≈ ~\$209k ARR

That is the honest ceiling of this ICP as currently priced. It is a real business and a bootstrap-viable one. It is not a venture-scale market at \$14–29/mo. If we ever need a bigger number, the lever is **price/tier** (moving upmarket toward the agency ceiling), not a looser ICP — loosening the ICP just re-creates the current situation: installs that can't convert.

11. How to use this document

Before adding any lead to the 50-lead sheet, run gates §2. If it fails a gate, it doesn't go on the sheet. A big list of unqualified stores is worse than a small list of qualified ones — it manufactures activity and hides the fact that we're not reaching the right people.

Before writing any copy, check §6. If the draft contains "CRO", "leaking funnel", or "AI CRO Expert", it's wrong regardless of how good it sounds.

Before believing a lead is hot, check the trigger (§5). No trigger = a fit, not a *now*.

When this doc is wrong, update it explicitly — with the evidence that changed, and the date. This is a living spec, but it changes by evidence, never by vibe.

Open questions to close via merchant interviews

- 1 Does the **redesign trigger** actually outrank the **paid-ads trigger** in our own funnel? (The research says redesign is the better *fit*; volume may say otherwise.)
- 2 Is **Beauty** actually reachable for us, or is Apparel the practical wedge given India's apparel over-index and our existing (weak) apparel toehold?
- 3 Does the **loop claim** (diagnose → deploy → attribute) land as differentiated with a merchant who already knows Wisepops/OptiMonk exist?
- 4 What did the ~18 below-floor stores *think* they were installing? Their answer tells us what our listing currently promises — and to whom it's wrongly aimed.

Sources

Primary sources only; blogspam and uncited statistics rejected.

- **Internal:** philosophy.md (P1, P4, P5, P6, P8), docs/founder/EXECUTION_PLAN_2026-05-20.md, app/services/billing.shared.ts (pricing), live production DB (TrafficDailyRollup, Shop, Billing) — 2026-07-17
- **Merchant vocabulary & triggers:** Shopify Community threads (linked verbatim in §5, §6); Shopify App Store reviews for Microsoft Clarity, MIDA, Propel
- **Market structure:** Store Leads Shopify reports (Jul 2026); Shopify FY2025 10-K & Q4 2025 results (SEC); Shopify FY2021 40-F (ARPU cross-check)
- **Benchmarks:** Littledata (n=2,800 Shopify sites) for CR; Dynamic Yield vertical benchmarks; Zoho PageSense + NN/g for heatmap/replay minimums
- **India:** Unicommerce India D2C Report 2026 (6,000+ brands, 410M shipments); Shopify India vs US pricing pages; Shopify managed-pricing docs

Known research limitation: Reddit was inaccessible to the research tooling (403/blocked crawler). All merchant quotes come from Shopify Community and App Store reviews — both primary sources with real merchants, but r/shopify's vocabulary is unsampled. Worth a manual pass if a vocabulary decision is ever close.